



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

2026-2031

FOCUS AREAS AND OBJECTIVES

The St Kevin's GFC Strategic Plan 2026–2031 sets out our shared vision for the future of our Club and the community it serves. It provides a clear and practical framework for sustaining and growing St Kevin's as a welcoming, inclusive, and volunteer-led club where People, Games, Participation, and Community are at the heart of everything we do.

This strategy reflects the voices of our members and wider community, shaped through engagement including our March 2025 Town Hall meeting. It builds on the foundations of our previous Strategic Plan and focuses on what matters most for the years ahead.

Our vision describes where we want to be by 2031 and this strategy sets out how we plan to get there; together.

Get Involved! Everyone Is Welcome

This strategy will only succeed with the continued involvement of our People. We warmly invite new and existing members to get involved in any way that suits your interests, skills, and availability.

If you would like to help with Coaching, we have a clear pathway in place for the development of new Coaches and it is open to everyone. Perhaps you are interested in more events and social activities? Whatever your suggestions or ideas, there is a place for you in St Kevin's GFC and everyone is welcome, regardless of experience.

We are keen to hear your ideas on how the Club can continue to support our community and grow in ways that matter to you. If you would like to get involved or share feedback, please contact any member of the Club Committee, or get in touch at:

@ secretary.stkevins.kildare@gaa.ie

☎ 087 638 5406



WHERE WE ALL BELONG

St Kevin's GFC is your club — get involved in whatever way plays to your strengths!



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

2026-2031

FOCUS AREAS AND OBJECTIVES

PURPOSE

St Kevins GFC purpose is to promote Gaelic games, culture and lifelong participation as a community-based, volunteer-led organisation which enriches lives and communities.

VISION

Our vision is a sustainable community-based and volunteer-led Club where as many as possible, participate in GAA, LGFA and club activities, for as long as possible.

VALUES

Community Identity
Inclusiveness Respect
Player Welfare Teamwork
and Volunteerism

TOP PRIORITIES

1. Maximum participation among players, coaches, and volunteers
2. A sustainable Club with membership at its core
3. A connected and inclusive Club
4. Good governance and efficient operations
5. Establishment of the appropriate number of working groups to focus on key strategic pillars and implement the strategy

1. GAMES

Providing the best possible games experience for players and spectators

- 1.1 Make Gaelic football as enjoyable as possible so that players stay playing and spectators enjoy watching games
- 1.2 Ensure players have an adequate number of meaningful games and an appropriate game to training ratio to improve participation and retention
- 1.3 Invest additional resources to safeguard the growth of St Kevins, its teams and its membership
- 1.4 Foster and consolidate St Kevins relationship with local second level and primary schools to develop a collaborative approach to player pathways in order to optimize the pipeline of talent available to the club and manage player workload and welfare

2. PEOPLE

Giving unrivalled role support and personal development opportunities to players, coaches and volunteers

- 2.1 Enable players to reach their potential through high-quality coaching, player supports, and games opportunities for all our players
- 2.2 Enhance support services to reduce the administrative obligations fulfilled by volunteers and generate a pipeline for future role and task holders
- 2.3 Engage with all centrally available GAA learning resources to ensure quality learning experiences and effective learning transfer for coaches, officers, players, and volunteers

3. CLUB & COMMUNITY

Supporting Club and community survival and growth

- 3.1 Champion the importance of diversity and inclusion to inspire players and members to participate in our games and activities
- 3.2 Formalise engagement with other community groups to pursue mutually beneficial goals and initiatives, e.g., health and wellbeing, physical activity, social inclusion, etc.
- 3.3 Grow the GAA locally through recognition of our close community connection including sharing players, members and interests with Coill Dubh Hurling and Camogie clubs

4. COMMUNICATION

Striving for a more connected Club

- 4.1 Develop a proactive communications culture across the Club to enhance our reputation, ensure the availability of up to date information in live time, and tell the St Kevins story in a contemporary way
- 4.2 Establish a greater connection with current and past members, players, coaches and volunteers
- 4.3 Give young people additional opportunities to develop as leaders and have their voices heard on the growth of the Club
- 4.4 Celebrate Irish Language and cultural activities through existing structures in the Association, eg Scor na n-Og

5. GOVERNANCE & OPERATIONS

Modernising our governance and operations

- 5.1 Maximise our One Club structure to include all our Gaelic games codes; Gaelic football, LGFA, and ongoing support for hurling and camogie in the community
- 5.2 Strengthen policy compliance and risk management measures to safeguard the club, community, and all members, particularly children
- 5.3 Engage and invest in digital technology, data and analytics to enhance the Club's operations and support the member growth strategy

6. RESOURCES

Ensuring the sustainability of St Kevins finances and facilities

- 6.1 Refocus the finance and fundraising activity on the growth of St Kevins teams and membership
- 6.2 Achieve long-term financial sustainability to fund the day-to-day running and strategic growth of the Club
- 6.3 Ensure Club facilities are developed and managed in a sustainable way
- 6.4 Equip members, players, coaches and volunteers to operate in an environmentally sustainable way to mitigate the effects of climate change on the Club and wider community



WHERE WE ALL BELONG



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

1. GAMES

PROVIDING THE BEST POSSIBLE GAMES EXPERIENCE FOR PLAYERS AND SPECTATORS

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Make Gaelic football as enjoyable as possible so that players stay playing and spectators enjoy watching games
- Ensure players have an adequate number of meaningful games and an appropriate game to training ratio to improve participation and retention
- Invest additional resources to safeguard the growth of St Kevins, its teams and its membership
- Foster and consolidate St Kevin's relationship with local second level and primary schools to develop a collaborative approach to player pathways in order to optimise the pipeline of talent available to the club and manage player workload and welfare

THE CORE ISSUE

WHAT WE WILL DO

HOW WE WILL DO IT

1.1 DEVELOPING THE GAMES

Make Gaelic football as enjoyable as possible so that players stay playing and spectators enjoy watching games

- Grow number of active qualified coaches through the existing GAA education framework
- Establish a Football Working Group to operationalise the implementation plan using the Club Coach Community of Practice Model
- Apply to enter the CCCOP Programme for 2026 (if available) aimed at coach development within the club supported by the external coach developer
- Align all policies and programmes to the Gaelic Games Coach and Player Pathways F1 (4-6), F2 (7-12), F3 (12+) which repositions Clubs at the centre of all player development and supports the progression to T1- T4 and E1 for some players
- Develop a club ethos for U12 – U23 of 'As many as possible for as long as possible' – 'Play and Stay' by minimising the barriers to participation and progression, eg, alternating coaches from year to year, emphasising fun, etc
- Re-establish the ethos and principles underpinning Go Games to ensure every child receives fair game time
- Introduce a co-ordinated dual nursery to include sessions designed around football, hurling/camogie, and fundamental movements
- Apply a patient and consistent approach

1.2 PROVIDING GAMES

Ensure players have an adequate number of meaningful games and an appropriate game to training ratio to improve participation and retention

- Ensure a minimum number of competitive or non-competitive games are provided for all players and all teams at a level appropriate to their ability and interest
- Establish additional teams at all ages and grades as necessary to provide the playing opportunities to all players regardless of ability

1.3 INVESTMENT

Invest additional resources to safeguard the growth of St Kevins, its teams and its membership

- Refocus the finance and fundraising activity on the growth of St Kevins teams and membership
- Implement a data-driven research approach to tracking participation levels and measuring programme impact
- Provide an appropriate range of required coaching and welfare supports to help players fulfil their potential at all stages of the pathways

1.4 COLLABORATING WITH THE EDUCATION SECTOR

Foster and consolidate St Kevins relationship with local second level and primary schools to develop a collaborative approach to player pathways in order to optimise the pipeline of talent available to the club and manage player workload and welfare

- Engage with the wider club membership to understand the player profile and their involvement in school (T1-T3, and college (T4) teams
- Establish relationships with primary schools in the wider community to commence a longitudinal study of local demographics and first club choices of primary school children
- Establish relationships and maintain regular engagement with teachers and school team coaches to gain an understanding of club player involvement and performance on school teams
- Engage with current F3 players to provide developmentally appropriate challenges that help them continue to enjoy the game, refine their skills, and foster a sense of belonging and being valued.
- Actively support school initiatives, fundraising efforts, and avail of club branding opportunities through school visits inviting those who may not currently be members of other clubs to join St Kevins for non-competitive play.



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

2. PEOPLE

GIVING UNRIVALLED ROLE SUPPORT AND PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES TO PLAYERS, COACHES AND VOLUNTEERS

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Enable players to reach their potential through high-quality coaching, player supports, and games opportunities for all our players
- Enhance support services to reduce the administrative obligations fulfilled by volunteers and generate a pipeline for future role and task holders
- Engage with all centrally available GAA learning resources to ensure quality learning experiences and effective learning transfer for coaches, officers, players, and volunteers

THE CORE ISSUE

WHAT WE WILL DO

HOW WE WILL DO IT

2.1 GROWING PLAYERS

Enable players to reach their potential through high-quality coaching, player supports, and games opportunities

- Align all policies and programmes to the Gaelic Games Player Pathway which repositions Clubs at the centre of player development
- Introduce an organisation-wide Club Health Check to promote self-sufficiency (building internal capability) and self-sustainability (growth)
- Implement a data-driven research approach to tracking participation levels and measuring programme impact
- Provide an appropriate range of required coaching and welfare supports to help players fulfil their potential at all stages of the pathways
- Leverage the existing GAA resources available to the Club to adopt an evidence based retention model to address player drop off and ensure the Club is a place for All
- Complete a comprehensive analysis of legacy member data sources to grow and retain the number of players available to teams at all levels
- Conduct player profiling to inform coaching needs and facilitate individual development plans
- Establish styles of play to suit our players

2.2 SUSTAINING VOLUNTEERISM

Enhance support services to reduce the administrative obligations fulfilled by volunteers and generate a pipeline for future role and task holders

- Identify and quantify the factors driving the current workload and establish practical policies to address the core issues
- Develop a portfolio of all task / role descriptions and responsibilities required to run the Club
- Streamline administrative tasks to support volunteers and centralise processes
- Provide both compulsory and optional training modules to help volunteers distinguish between 'must-do' and 'should-do' tasks
- Support members with more opportunities to volunteer in whatever way possible to feel valued and to engender a sense of engagement and belonging
- Give young people more opportunities to volunteer, e.g., promote graduated learning and leadership pathways, facilitate vetting and safeguarding to support underage training etc
- Identify capability within the Club Membership
- Provide engagement opportunities to new and recent members as part of joining process
- Ask People to Help
- Establish the required number of working groups to operationalise the implementation plan as agreed by the Club Executive
- Encourage participation in referee development programmes

2.3 CONTINUOUS PEOPLE DEVELOPMENT

Engage with all centrally available GAA learning resources to ensure quality learning experiences and effective learning transfer for coaches, officers, players, and volunteers

- Mandate self directed learning approach using all learning resources available from the GAA relevant to your role or task
- Research partnerships with external institutions and training providers for additional development as required
- Build TY and Gaisce programme placements into Club activity, eg, coaching, Green and Healthy Club initiatives, etc
- Develop Club specific learning or support resources as identified on a needs basis



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

3. CLUB AND COMMUNITY

SUPPORTING CLUB AND COMMUNITY SURVIVAL AND GROWTH

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Champion the importance of diversity and inclusion to inspire players and members to participate in our games and activities
- Formalise engagement with other community groups to pursue mutually beneficial goals and initiatives, e.g., health and wellbeing, physical activity, social inclusion, etc.
- Grow the GAA locally through recognition of our close community connection including sharing players, members and interests with Coill Dubh Hurling and Camogie clubs

THE CORE ISSUE

WHAT WE WILL DO

HOW WE WILL DO IT

3.1 CHAMPIONING DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION

Champion the importance of diversity and inclusion to inspire players and members to participate in our games and activities

- Work with coaches, players, volunteers and members to foster an inclusive culture in the Club including the ongoing development and expansion of the Allstars initiative model to other club teams
- Utilise resources and supports from the GAA and Sport Ireland to promote and increase participation among children, adolescents and adults from all groups in society
- Support the GAA's diversity and inclusion function to increase awareness, and best practices for equality, diversity and inclusion including the ongoing liaison with Kildare GAA and Croke Park to position the Club as the National Standard for the GAA for All Model
- Ensure Working Groups and coaching panels are diverse and inclusive and actively demonstrate the opportunities for the involvement of all individuals in our Club

3.2 STRENGTHENING PUBLIC AND COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

Formalise engagement with other community groups to pursue mutually beneficial goals and initiatives, e.g., health and wellbeing, physical activity, social inclusion, etc.

- Liaise with the Community to identify an additional initiative to complement the Allstars programme and achieve 'Healthy Club' Status
- Liaise with the Community and Kildare County Council to implement a maintenance arrangement regarding waste management and other climate and sustainability initiatives and achieve 'Green Club' Status
- Engage with the Community and Training Providers to explore opportunities to utilise St Kevins premises for other purposes on a commercial and non-commercial basis

3.3 GROWING THE GAA LOCALLY

Grow the GAA locally through recognition of our close community connection including sharing players, members and interests with Coill Dubh Hurling and Camogie clubs

- Liaise with Coill Dubh Hurling Club Executive and Management on the development of a Memorandum of Understanding and a training and playing schedule for the benefit of both clubs and the retention and welfare of dual players at all ages
- Assess St Kevins Club capacity to support other clubs in our community to deliver on mutual objectives and support the growth of our club
- Maintain a close relationship with other sporting bodies in the community to manage player welfare and to ensure players can continue to play GAA for as long as possible.



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

4. COMMUNICATION

STRIVING FOR A MORE CONNECTED CLUB

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Develop a proactive communications culture across the Club to enhance our reputation, ensure the availability of up to date information in live time, and tell the St Kevins story in a contemporary way
- Establish a greater connection with current and past members, players, coaches and volunteers
- Give young people additional opportunities to develop as leaders and have their voices heard on the growth of the Club
- Celebrate Irish language and cultural activities through existing structures within the Association eg Scor na n-Og

THE CORE ISSUE	WHAT WE WILL DO	HOW WE WILL DO IT
4.1 PROACTIVE COMMUNICATIONS	Develop a proactive communications culture across the Club to enhance our reputation, ensure the availability of up to date information in live time, and tell the St Kevins story in a contemporary way	• Review required roles for communications and digital officers to ensure ongoing and regular updates and information sharing with all stakeholders • Continually review and renew our social media policy and guidelines to reflect the role that social media plays in the lives of our members, the wider community, and young people in particular • Mandate a self-directed learning approach using all learning resources available from the GAA relevant to the role(s) or task • Develop an online Club Calendar, maintained in live time, to reflect the totality of club sporting and social activity
4.2 CONNECTING WITH MEMBERS AND FOLLOWERS	Establish a greater connection with current and past members, players and volunteers	• Design and curate a 'Member Welcome Pack' issued to all at joining and renewal to enable the sense of belonging and immediate connection to all elements of club activity and people • Explore ways to make the current access channels more open to all members, specifically the access to St Kevins Club Notes, the redesign and management of the St Kevins website, and the consideration of the publication of a hard copy newsletter for those members not active on social media. • Design and implement processes for two-way dialogue with all stakeholders including an initiative to reconnect with all global and past 'first club' members
4.3 ENGAGING YOUNG PEOPLE	Give young people additional opportunities to develop as leaders and have their voices heard on the growth of the club	• Establish a programme of engagement with primary and second level school pupils, and Third Level/PLC students including a schedule of targeted development opportunities to develop coaching skills, secure Garda Vetting & Safeguarding, and support the coaching of underage teams • Explore opportunities for young people to develop leadership skills through the ongoing development and expansion of the Allstars initiative model to other club teams, TY / Gaisce programmes, and green / healthy club initiatives • Support youth access to national programmes e.g., the Future Leaders Transition Year Programme, the Dermot Early Youth Leadership initiative, and the Club Leadership Development Programme • Create a forum for two way dialogue around scheduled welfare and youth related wellness expert led talks and topics
4.4 CELEBRATING OUR IRISH LANGUAGE AND CULTURE	Celebrate Irish Language and cultural activities through existing structures within the Association eg Scor na n-Og	• Incentivise members to engage with Scór by participation and performing in activities through partnerships with other clubs • Provide enhanced support for Fondúireacht Sheosaimh Mhic Dhonncha to support Clubs and Counties wishing to further the Irish language in their communities • Engage with local performance arts groups to establish partnerships that support mutually beneficial objectives around hosting and promoting modern creative and expressive arts forms



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

5. GOVERNANCE AND OPERATIONS

MODERNISING OUR GOVERNANCE AND OPERATIONS

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Maximise our One Club structure to include all our Gaelic games codes; Gaelic football, LGFA, and ongoing support for hurling and camogie in the community
- Strengthen policy compliance and risk management measures to safeguard our Club, community, and all members, particularly children
- Engage and invest in digital technology, data and analytics to enhance the Club's operations and support the member growth strategy

THE CORE ISSUE	WHAT WE WILL DO	HOW WE WILL DO IT
5.1 ONE CLUB	Maximise our One Club structure to include all our Gaelic games codes; Gaelic football, LGFA, and ongoing support for hurling and camogie in the community	• Ensure fair allocation of use of playing facilities across all codes • Ensure both codes are adequately represented on all Club Committees and Working Groups • Maximise the greater opportunity for larger fundraising from the One Club structure through the mandating of a co-ordinated approach and strategy to finance and fundraising. • Continue to collaborate with Coill Dubh Hurling and Camogie Clubs to support the growth of the GAA in the wider community and to enable players to continue to engage safely and seamlessly in as many codes as possible
5.2 SAFEGUARDING PEOPLE	Strengthen policy compliance and risk management measures to safeguard our Club, community, and all members, particularly children	• Ensure full compliance with statutory and the GAA's child safeguarding responsibilities from all coaches working with underage players • Ensure completion of Child Safeguarding Risk Assessment procedures biennially and also publish and display a Child Safeguarding Statement for the same time period • Develop an awareness of adult related safeguarding priorities eg, anti-bullying, substance dependency, mental health, etc • Introduce mandatory training requirements for critical areas of governance and administration
5.3 INVESTING IN DIGITAL AND DATA	Engage and Invest in digital technology, data and analytics to enhance the Club's operations and support the member growth strategy	• Design and deliver an innovative digital strategy focused on digital communications, social media, data analytics, mobile and cloud technologies • Invest in relevant tools and technology to track participation levels and measure programme impact and data collection to facilitate planning, decision-making and reporting • Enhance systems, processes and training to develop the management of information assets including financial records, data, documentation, meeting minutes, statistics, imagery and video



ST KEVINS GFC STRATEGIC PLAN SUMMARY

6. RESOURCES

ENSURING THE SUSTAINABILITY OF ST KEVINS FINANCES AND FACILITIES

SUMMARY OF WHAT WE WILL DO

- Refocus the finance and fundraising activity on the growth of St Kevins, its teams and its membership
- Achieve long-term financial sustainability to fund the day-to-day running and strategic growth of the Club
- Ensure Club facilities are developed and managed in a sustainable way
- Equip members, players, coaches and volunteers to operate in an environmentally sustainable way to mitigate the effects of climate change on the Club and wider community

THE CORE ISSUE	WHAT WE WILL DO	HOW WE WILL DO IT
6.1 RE-BALANCING CLUB RESOURCING	Refocus the finance and fundraising activity on the growth of St Kevins, its teams and its membership	• Appoint a Registrar with oversight of management of membership review, registration and KPIs • Review the Membership Types on offer to ensure a range of appropriate membership offerings to suit all stakeholders • Transition all Membership activity to Foireann to streamline operations and integrate to GAA systems • Review legacy membership data sources to achieve a baseline status • Agree KPIs for membership growth based on a range of player age profiles, community demographics, wider club activities, past 'first club' members etc • Executive to agree 'red line' policies relating player activity to membership type and status
6.2 ACHIEVING FINANCIAL SUSTAINABILITY	Achieve long-term financial sustainability to fund the day-to-day running and strategic growth of the Club	• Standardise financial systems and procedures across the Club and Bar and introduce financial reporting as a standard item at Executive meetings • Executive to monitor oversight to identify and mitigate financial governance risks • Agree a budget plan for the required ring fenced and allocated investment for each team as appropriate • Maximise the greater opportunity for larger fundraising from the One Club structure through the mandating of a co-ordinated approach and strategy to finance and fundraising. • Engage an additional Executive member to assume responsibility for identification and application for grants and loans • Grow the Club's commercial income - particularly through integrated sponsorship and business partnerships to support strategic priorities
6.3 ATTAINING SAFE AND SUSTAINABLE FACILITIES	Ensure Club facilities are developed and managed in a sustainable way	• Establish what facilities are available or needed across the Club recognising the primary focus of this strategy is the growth of St Kevins teams and membership • Engage with other sporting and community groups to establish potential for shared resourcing of facilities based on collaborating on grant and funding applications • Establish and resource maintenance working group to schedule and oversee ongoing upkeep and works.
6.4 LEADING ENVIRONMENTAL SUSTAINABILITY	Equip members, players, coaches and volunteers to operate in an environmentally sustainable way to mitigate the effects of climate change on the Club and wider community	• Ensure the Green Clubs Programme for Gaelic Games is adequately resourced and implemented • Promote the internal and external supports available to all teams and members seeking to improve the sustainability of how they conduct their activity within the club